Phishing Identification Checklist

Pause, verify and report before you click.

Check the sender

- Compare the display name with the full email address.
- Treat unexpected messages from known contacts as unverified until confirmed through another channel.
- Watch for look-alike domains, extra characters and unusual reply-to addresses.

Check the request

- Be cautious with urgency, secrecy, payment changes, password resets and requests for one-time codes.
- Do not approve an MFA prompt you did not initiate.
- Never send passwords, recovery codes or private keys by email or chat.

Check links and attachments

- Hover over links and inspect the real destination before opening.
- Avoid unexpected archives, macro-enabled documents and executable files.
- Open important services from a trusted bookmark instead of the message link.

If suspicious

- Do not reply or forward the message to colleagues.
- Use the organisation's reporting process and preserve the original message.
- If you clicked, disconnect only when instructed, report immediately and change exposed credentials from a trusted device.

Use this guide with your organisation's policies and incident contacts. For urgent events, follow the approved escalation path immediately.